

AGENT GUARDRAILS

A second reader the agent cannot skip

On 9 October two emails drafted by an agent went out signed with the author's name. The fix was built that day.

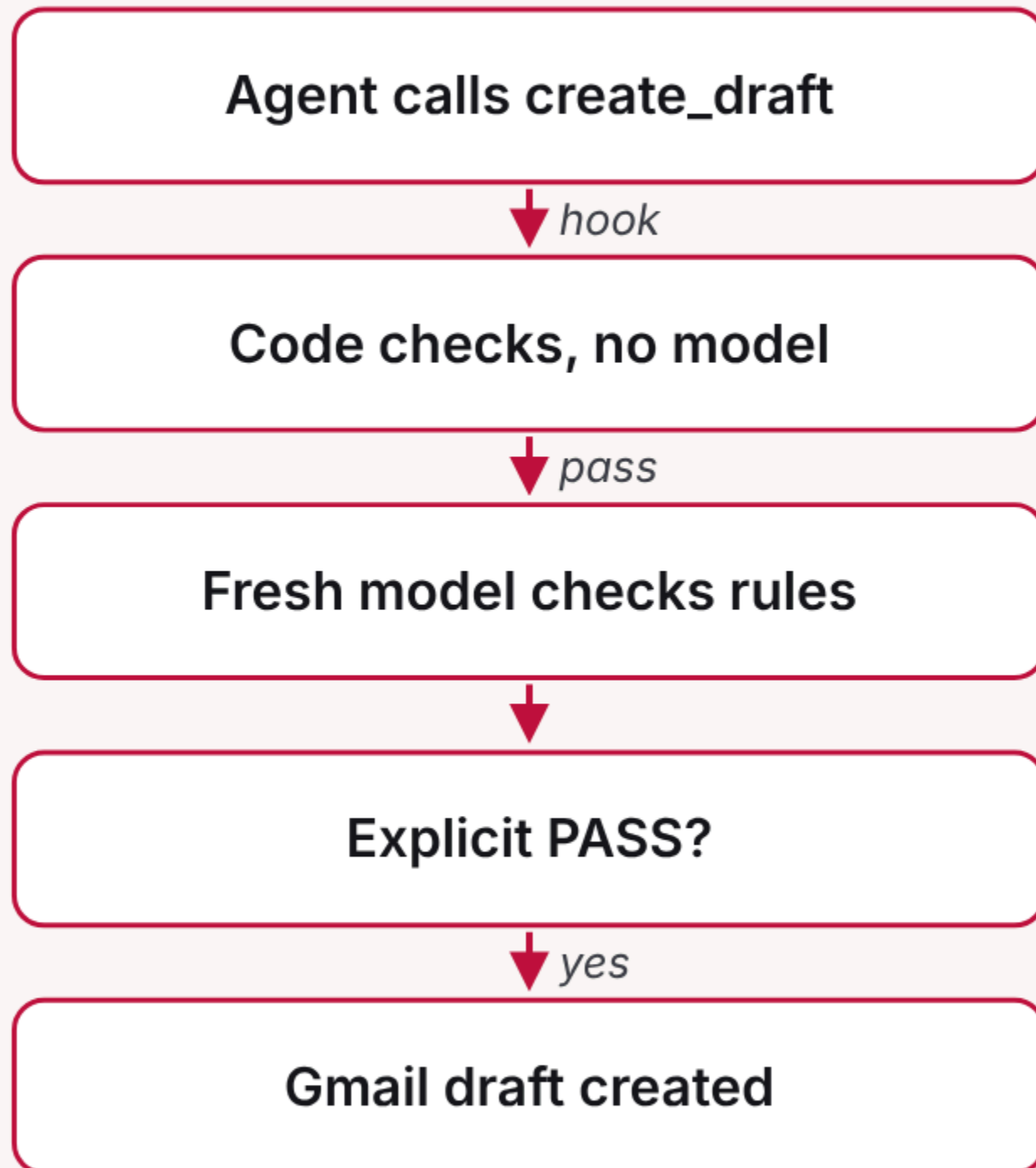
Why a rule written four times failed

Only the agent's memory enforced it

The agent was the only reader of its draft

The rule was lost when the conversation was summarised

Every draft now passes through a guard



Anything else denies the draft. Every verdict is logged.

The checker gets less than the author, on purpose

No conversation history

No tools

A different model: Sonnet checks Opus

Only the rules, the sources and the draft

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*An email that is late is a small cost.
An email that goes out wrong cannot
be taken back.*

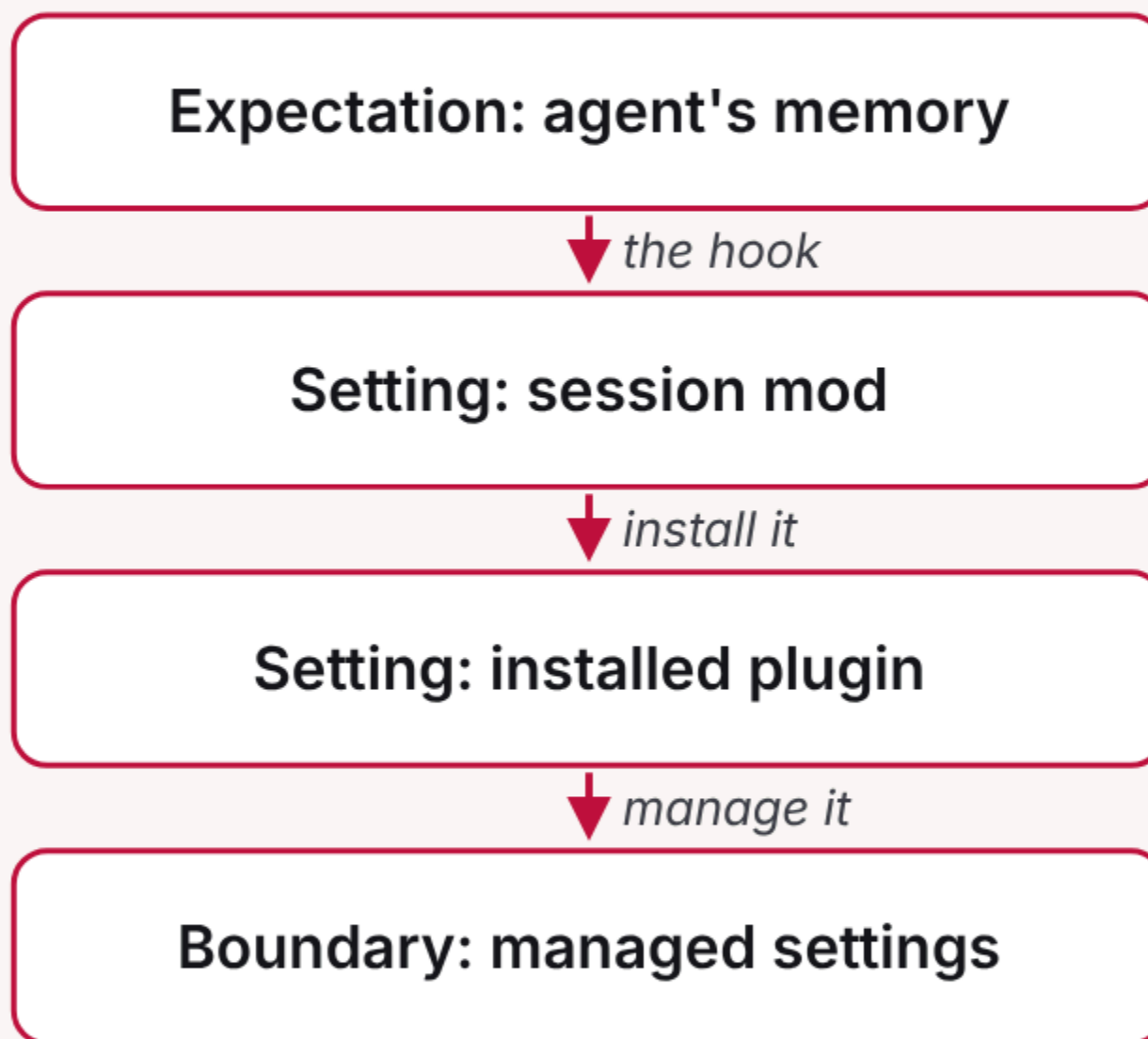
THE INBOX AGENT, ON FAILING CLOSED

4

invented claims caught on the first run

Statements presented as the author's view or promise that were not in anything he had said.

Where the hook lives decides what it is



Same code, different owner. Only the last is a control.

Banks call it maker-checker

Segregation of duties, the two-person rule, the independent double check. The idea is old; the agent version now has a precise shape.

Put a gate on the call that matters

Code checks first, then a fresh checker. Deny on anything but an explicit PASS. Log every verdict.

sgit.ai/articles/a-second-reader-the-agent-cannot-skip.html